National Health and Aging Trends Study (NHATS)

Round 4 Public Use Data – Final Release Version 2

README FILE

The NHATS R4 Public Use Final Release SAS Zip File contains 18 files (in addition to this README file). Files are described briefly below, with file names shown in **bold**.

SAS DATA FILES & FORMATS

Four SAS data files (version 9.4) are included:

NHATS_Round_4_SP_File.sas7bdat contains the sample person (SP) and the facility questionnaire (FQ) data (4,737 observations and 1,111 variables).

NHATS_Round_4_OP_File.sas7bdat contains the other person (OP) data (33,016 observations and 277 variables).

NHATS_Round_4_Tracker_File_V2.sas7bdat contains tracking information for all persons sampled for NHATS (12,411 observations and 340 variables).

NHATS_Round_4_MetNonMet.sas7bdat contains metro/nonmetro geographic information for all persons who completed an NHATS interview (4,737 observations and 2 variables).

PROC FORMAT statements are provided in

NHATS_Round_4_Combined_PROC_FORMAT_Statement.sas for the first three files combined and **NHATS_Round_4_MetNonMet_PROC_FORMAT.sas** for metro/nonmetro file. (Users who prefer to disable the formats may use the statement OPTIONS NOFMTERR.)

ASCII FIXED FORMAT TEXT FILES

Four ASCII files are included: **NHATS_Round_4_SP_File.txt**, **NHATS_Round_4_OP_File.txt**, **NHATS_Round_4_Tracker_File_V2.txt**, and **NHATS_Round_4_MetNonMet.txt**.

Users may create their own SAS file by reading in the ASCII files with the provided SAS program files: **NHATS_Round_4_SP_READ.sas**, **NHATS_Round_4_OP_READ.sas**, **NHATS_Round_4_Tracker_READ_V2.sas**, and **NHATS_Round_4_MetNonMet_READ.sas**.

Each SAS program contains four sections: (1) a section setting up the pre-defined formats, (2) an input statement, which identifies the starting position of each variable in the ASCII file, (3) a section mapping variables to specific formats, and (4) a section that provides descriptive variable labels, which can be mapped back to the Instrument. Alternatively, users may adapt these SAS programs as needed to import the ASCII data into other software packages.

CODEBOOK FREQUENCIES

Frequencies (and means for many continuous variables) are included in:

NHATS_Round_4_SP_Frequencies.pdf
NHATS_Round_4_OP_Frequencies.pdf
NHATS_Round_4_Tracker_Frequencies_V2.pdf
NHATS_Round_4_MetNonMet_Frequencies.pdf

For each variable, the variable name and label is included along with value labels and associated numeric values.

ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTATION

Additional documentation is available on the NHATS website (www.NHATS.org) and includes: the Round 4 Instruments (annotated with variable names and labels), User Guide, Crosswalk between instrument items and codebooks, and various technical papers.

QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS

If you have questions or concerns that are not addressed here or in documentation found at www.NHATS.org, please feel free to contact us at NHATSdata@westat.com.